



The fundamental principles of Material Design –
Google's attempt at a unified design language.

Google's Material Design

Douglas Bowman was the first classically trained visual designer Google hired. He joined in 2006, when Google was already seven years old. As he wrote in his blog post after leaving Google in 2009, seven years was a long time for a company to function purely driven by data. When design decisions have been taken by engineers for so long, they become engineering decisions.

Google's obsession with data has not eased up in the past half a decade. If anything, it has only intensified with the spread of Android. But from being a company whose logos on different products were several pixels off, Google is today a pioneer in the field of design as well. Material Design is a bold new attempt by Google to create, in their words, “a visual language,” which aims to “develop a single underlying system that allows for a unified experience across platforms and device sizes.”

Material Design builds upon all the basic principles of flat design discussed above, with added thoughtful touches relevant to its own user interfaces across all Google products, most notably Android. Every shadow,



Material Design represents the pinnacle of
development of flat design.